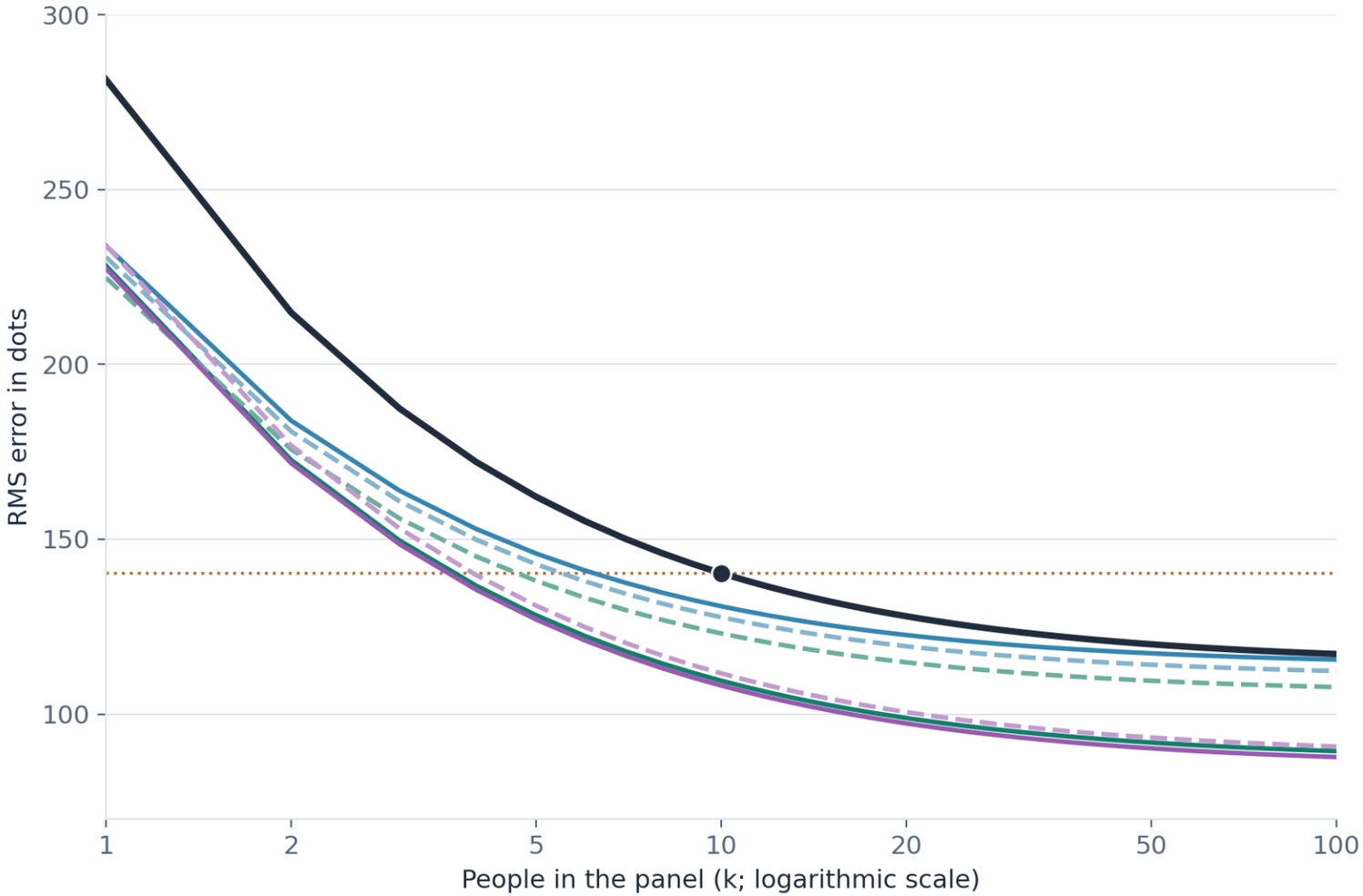
Panel accuracy across survey formats

901 people estimated the same nine dot counts. Each curve averages over all possible panels of k people.
The panel prediction is the mean of its members' estimates. Lower error is better.



RESPONSE FORMAT

- Type a number
- Drag / endpoints
- Click / endpoints
- Drag / midpoint
- Click / midpoint
- Drag / quartiles
- Click / quartiles

10 typed responses

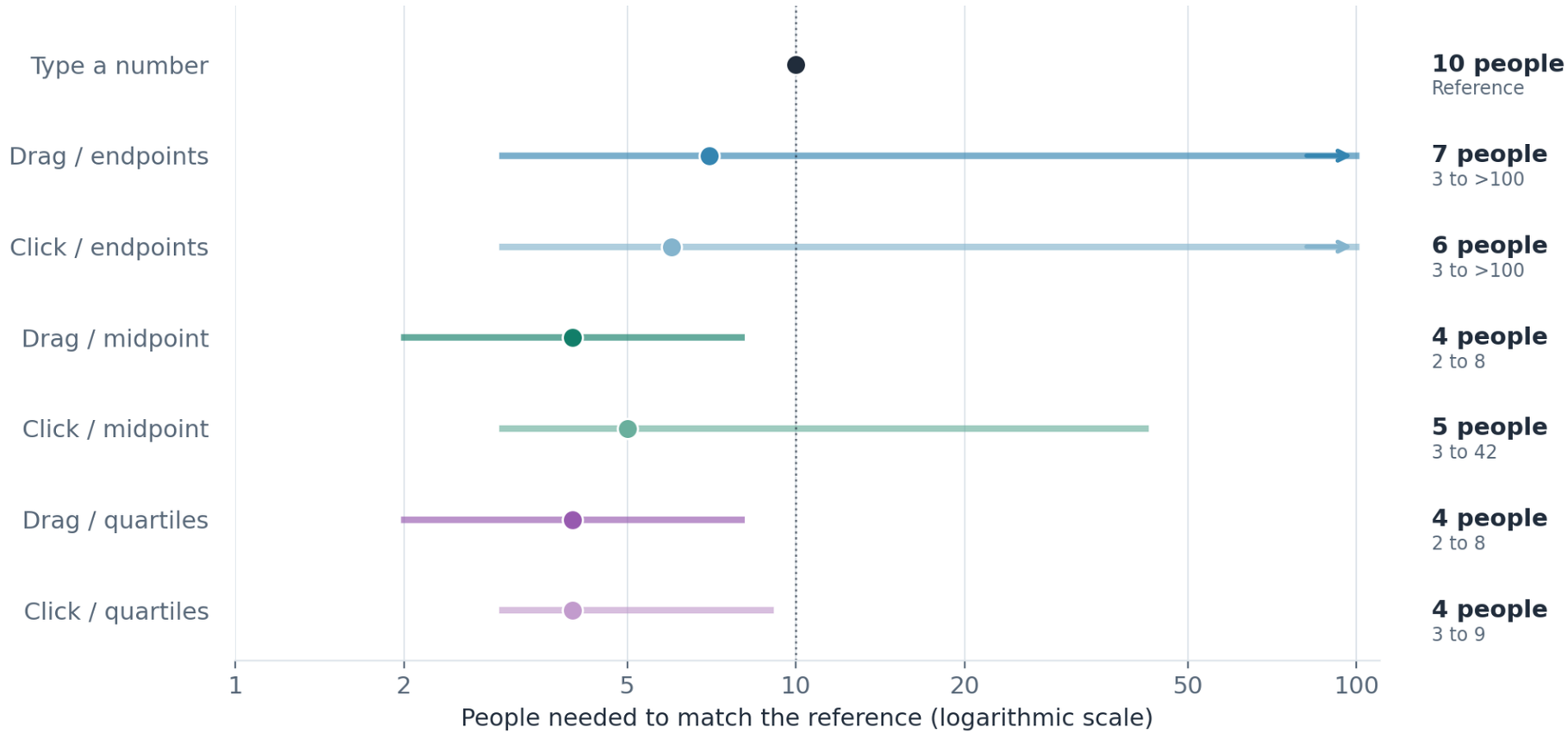
140.3 dots RMS error

Reference for the next page

Exact finite-pool expectations, not simulated responses. Curves cover k = 1-100.
RMS = square root of expected mean squared error across the nine fixed images.
Source: Honda, Kagawa & Shirasuna (2022) | Data: osf.io/sxdf9 | Analysis: 23 Sep 2026

How many people match 10 typed responses?

Target: no more than 140.3 dots RMS error. Dots show the smallest qualifying whole-person panel.
Lines show 95% respondent-bootstrap intervals, including uncertainty in the reference target.

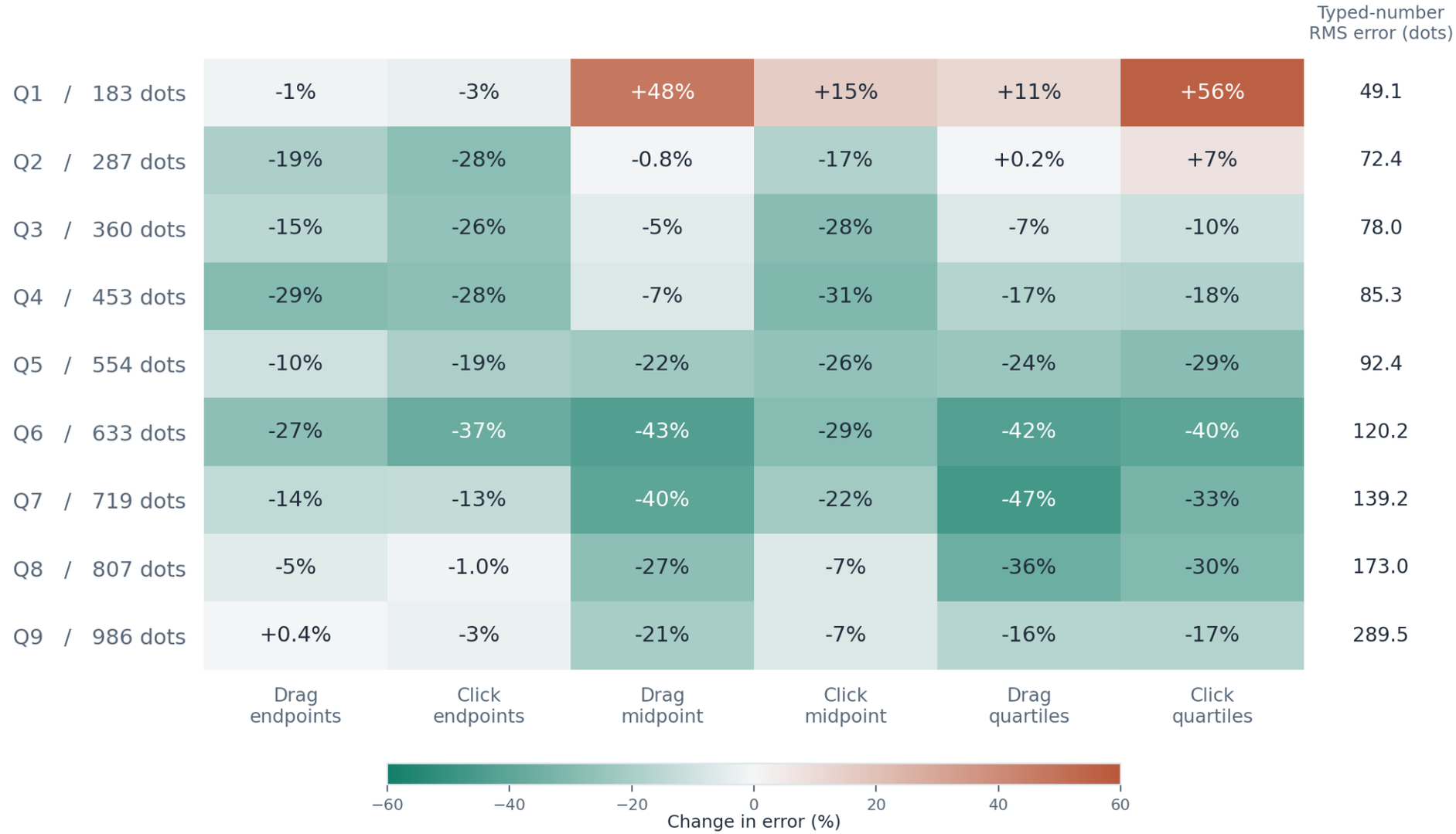


Point estimates: 4-7 scale respondents match 10 typed-number respondents.

2,000 bootstrap draws resample whole people; the nine images stay fixed. Arrows indicate an upper bound beyond 100.
Intervals do not describe new questions. Bootstrap draws without a crossing are retained, not extrapolated.
Source: Honda, Kagawa & Shirasuna (2022) | Data: osf.io/sxdf9 | Analysis: 23 Sep 2026

The comparison changes by question

All panels have 10 people. Cells show the percent change in RMS error relative to typing a number.
Negative values favor the scale format; positive values favor typing a number.



These are descriptive comparisons for nine fixed images, not nine independent experiments.
The overall curve gives each image equal weight before taking the square root.
Source: Honda, Kagawa & Shirasuna (2022) | Data: osf.io/sxdf9 | Analysis: 23 Sep 2026